
EN578-26ISC1 solicitation amendment

This solicitation amendment 001 is raised to answer Offeror's questions and amend the solicitation:

1. Respond to questions from industry;
 2. Amend the Solicitation at Section 20.1. item a, to add a definition; and
 3. Amend the Solicitation at Section 20.2. item b, to change the Problem Statement title.
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1. Respond to questions from industry.

Questions and Answers

Question #1: Although the Arctic and coastal RPAS problem statement is focused on RPAS, one listed outcome refers to "autonomous or remotely operated surface and underwater platforms" and multi-domain systems that integrate ground capabilities for personnel/equipment transport and operational monitoring. Could you please confirm whether a ground-only, remotely operated fleet mobility solution could be eligible under this outcome?

Answer #1: Outcome #5 is seeking surface and underwater platforms as well as modular, multi-domain systems that integrate aerial, ground, or marine capabilities. A ground-only solution would be considered in scope as part of the request for "surface" platforms. The title of the problem statement has been adjusted to "Arctic and Coastal Uncrewed Systems".

Question #2: A supplier is seeking clarification regarding Outcomes #24 and #28 under the category "Quantum and quantum-safe communication technologies." Are software-based post-quantum cryptography (PQC) and quantum-safe communications solutions considered in scope for Outcomes #24 and #28 or are these outcomes intended only for quantum hardware-based technologies?

Answer #2: Software-based post-quantum cryptography (PQC) and quantum-safe communications solutions are both considered to be in scope for Outcomes #24 and #28.

Question #3: Can you please provide further clarification on what is meant by the "significant modification of an existing technology or processes" under "pre-commercial status"?

Answer #3: In this context, “significant modification” refers to meaningful changes in how existing technologies, components, or processes are applied, rather than entirely new inventions. Specifically, it involves adapting or reconfiguring what already exists so that it can be used in new settings or conditions where it was not previously possible or feasible, including in government applications. In other words, even if the underlying technology is not new, the way it is modified and applied must enable a substantively different use case or capability that could not be achieved through its current, standard implementation.

Question #4: A supplier is asking whether a prototype focused on verifiable business trust indicators or credential-style status display could fit the supplier verification and decentralized credentialing problem statement or if it is limited to GC supplier status credentials issued from PSPC data.

Answer #4: The government is seeking solutions that can aggregate all publicly available government of Canada contract data (i.e. Open Data and CanadaBuys Contract History). The solution is not limited to PSPC data.

2. At Section 20.1, item a, at page 31 to 32 of the Solicitation of Offers document:

DELETE the following in its entirety:

a. Problem Statement: Supplier verification and decentralized credentialing .

Preamble:

The Government of Canada (GC) relies on a wide network of suppliers to deliver goods and services. For small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), demonstrating verified “Government of Canada supplier” status is important to demonstrate credibility and access opportunities. Current processes for validating and displaying supplier status depend on centralized systems and manual intervention by Public Services and Procurement Canada (PSPC), which can introduce delays, administrative burden, and limit scalability.

Technologies that leverage digital credentials, identity and trust frameworks, as well as automated verification infrastructure present an opportunity to modernize how supplier credentials are issued, verified, and shared. These technologies can enable tamper-resistant, real-time validation of supplier status while reducing reliance on manual processes and intermediaries.

The GC is interested in testing solutions to enable suppliers to independently display and verify a “Government of Canada supplier” status. These solutions should support secure credential issuance, real-time validation, interoperability across platforms, and alignment with federal standards for data protection, identity management, and digital trust. The solutions will interface with publicly available

data to determine supplier status and generate a tamper-proof and real-time verifiable, portable credential.

Definitions:

- Blockchain (distributed ledger technology): A decentralized and distributed digital ledger that records transactions across multiple systems in a way that ensures data integrity, transparency, and immutability without requiring a central authority.
- Digital credential: A verifiable digital representation of a qualification, status, or attribute (such as supplier certification) that can be securely issued, stored, and shared electronically.
- Decentralized identity (DID): A model for managing digital identities that allows individuals or organizations to control their own identity information without relying on a central authority.
- Smart contract: Self-executing code stored on a blockchain that automatically enforces rules or agreements when predefined conditions are met.
- Verification: The process of confirming the authenticity and validity of a supplier's status or credentials through cryptographic or authoritative means.

Outcomes:

Innovations must meet at least one or more of the following outcomes to fulfill the requirements of the Screening Criteria 4 Evaluation Grid:

1. Solutions that enable the GC to issue secure, tamper-resistant digital credentials that can confirm a company's supplier to the GC status. Solutions must provide suppliers with embeddable, dynamic trust indicators that are capable of interactive verification by users in a single click or scan. Solutions must allow suppliers to easily display and share their verified GC supplier status (e.g., via websites, procurement platforms, or digital profiles) without requiring manual PSPC intervention (supplier self-service verification tools).

Out of scope:

Innovative Solutions Canada (ISC) will not accept any of the following:

- Solutions that rely solely on manual validation processes or require ongoing PSPC intervention for credential display or verification.
- Solutions that do not incorporate secure methods for preventing credential tampering, fraud, or unauthorized access.

- Solutions that fail to comply with applicable federal policies on privacy, security, and digital trust.

And **INSERT** the following :

b. Problem Statement: Supplier verification and decentralized credentialing .

Preamble:

The Government of Canada (GC) relies on a wide network of suppliers to deliver goods and services. For small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), demonstrating verified “Government of Canada supplier” status is important to demonstrate credibility and access opportunities. Current processes for validating and displaying supplier status depend on centralized systems and manual intervention by Public Services and Procurement Canada (PSPC), which can introduce delays, administrative burden, and limit scalability.

Technologies that leverage digital credentials, identity and trust frameworks, as well as automated verification infrastructure present an opportunity to modernize how supplier credentials are issued, verified, and shared. These technologies can enable tamper-resistant, real-time validation of supplier status while reducing reliance on manual processes and intermediaries.

The GC is interested in testing solutions to enable suppliers to independently display and verify a “Government of Canada supplier” status. These solutions should support secure credential issuance, real-time validation, interoperability across platforms, and alignment with federal standards for data protection, identity management, and digital trust. The solutions will interface with publicly available data to determine supplier status and generate a tamper-proof and real-time verifiable, portable credential.

Definitions:

- Tamper-resistant (or tamper-proof): Prevention and unauthorized duplication, copying, misuse and alteration while being able to be independently verified in real-time. Each credential is protected using encrypted verification technology, ensuring authenticity allowing buyers/suppliers to instantly confirm validity directly from the source. If any tampering were to occur, it would also be immediately detectable by verifiers.
- Blockchain (distributed ledger technology): A decentralized and distributed digital ledger that records transactions across multiple systems in a way that ensures data integrity, transparency, and immutability without requiring a central authority.
- Digital credential: A verifiable digital representation of a qualification, status, or attribute (such as supplier certification) that can be securely issued, stored, and shared electronically.

- Decentralized identity (DID): A model for managing digital identities that allows individuals or organizations to control their own identity information without relying on a central authority.
- Smart contract: Self-executing code stored on a blockchain that automatically enforces rules or agreements when predefined conditions are met.
- Verification: The process of confirming the authenticity and validity of a supplier's status or credentials through cryptographic or authoritative means.

Outcomes:

Innovations must meet at least one or more of the following outcomes to fulfill the requirements of the Screening Criteria 4 Evaluation Grid:

2. Solutions that enable the GC to issue secure, tamper-resistant digital credentials that can confirm a company's supplier to the GC status. Solutions must provide suppliers with embeddable, dynamic trust indicators that are capable of interactive verification by users in a single click or scan. Solutions must allow suppliers to easily display and share their verified GC supplier status (e.g., via websites, procurement platforms, or digital profiles) without requiring manual PSPC intervention (supplier self-service verification tools).

Out of scope:

Innovative Solutions Canada (ISC) will not accept any of the following:

- Solutions that rely solely on manual validation processes or require ongoing PSPC intervention for credential display or verification.
- Solutions that do not incorporate secure methods for preventing credential tampering, fraud, or unauthorized access.

Solutions that fail to comply with applicable federal policies on privacy, security, and digital trust.

3. At Section 20 Problem Statements, item b, at page 33 to 34 of the Solicitation of Offers document:

DELETE the following in its entirety:

b. Problem Statement: Arctic and Coastal Remotely Piloted Aircraft Systems (RPAS).

Preamble:

The operations of the Royal Canadian Mounted Police (RCMP) and the Department of National Defence (DND), Canadian Armed Forces (CAF) in northern and Arctic regions face extreme cold, icing, humidity,

reduced visibility, and limited infrastructure. Many RPAS systems experience degraded performance or reduced availability under these conditions, limiting their effectiveness for search and rescue (SAR), surveillance, transportation, and public safety missions.

RCMP and the CAF are interested in testing autonomous, remotely piloted, and modular multi-domain solutions specifically designed or adapted for prolonged coastal or cold weather operations.

Definitions:

- Arctic operations: Sustained performance at temperatures down to -25°C.
- Coastal operations: Sustained performance at temperatures down to -10°C with at least 48 hours of saltwater exposure.
- Multi-domain systems: systems that are designed to operate across multiple domains or environments, including space, aerial, ground-based, underground or underwater. The term "multi-domain" indicates that these systems are not limited to a single type of environment or application; instead, they can function effectively in a variety of environments.

Outcomes:

Innovations must meet at least one or more of the following outcomes to fulfill the requirements of the Screening Criteria 4 Evaluation Grid:

4. RPAS solutions that incorporate one of the following technologies to improve cold weather operations in arctic conditions:
 - a. Integrated de-icing solutions for airframes, propulsion systems, or sensors;
 - b. Humidity and condensation control to protect avionics and payloads;
 - c. Cold-weather endurance and rapid redeployment capability; or
 - d. Integrated camera payloads (e.g., electro-optical, infrared, low-light) optimized for high-visibility and SAR applications.
5. Autonomous or remotely operated surface and underwater platforms as well as modular, multi-domain systems that integrate aerial, ground, or marine capabilities that can support complex Arctic or coastal missions, including personnel and equipment transport as well as environmental or operational monitoring, under Arctic and coastal conditions.

And **INSERT** the following:

b. Problem Statement: Arctic and Coastal Uncrewed Systems.

Preamble:

The operations of the Royal Canadian Mounted Police (RCMP) and the Department of National Defence (DND), Canadian Armed Forces (CAF) in northern and Arctic regions face extreme cold, icing, humidity, reduced visibility, and limited infrastructure. Many RPAS systems experience degraded performance or reduced availability under these conditions, limiting their effectiveness for search and rescue (SAR), surveillance, transportation, and public safety missions.

RCMP and the CAF are interested in testing autonomous, remotely piloted, and modular multi-domain solutions specifically designed or adapted for prolonged coastal or cold weather operations.

Definitions:

- Arctic operations: Sustained performance at temperatures down to -25°C.
- Coastal operations: Sustained performance at temperatures down to -10°C with at least 48 hours of saltwater exposure.
- Multi-domain systems: systems that are designed to operate across multiple domains or environments, including space, aerial, ground-based, underground or underwater. The term "multi-domain" indicates that these systems are not limited to a single type of environment or application; instead, they can function effectively in a variety of environments.

Outcomes:

Innovations must meet at least one or more of the following outcomes to fulfill the requirements of the Screening Criteria 4 Evaluation Grid:

4. RPAS solutions that incorporate one of the following technologies to improve cold weather operations in arctic conditions:
 - a. Integrated de-icing solutions for airframes, propulsion systems, or sensors;
 - b. Humidity and condensation control to protect avionics and payloads;
 - c. Cold-weather endurance and rapid redeployment capability; or
 - d. Integrated camera payloads (e.g., electro-optical, infrared, low-light) optimized for high-visibility and SAR applications.



5. Autonomous or remotely operated surface and underwater platforms as well as modular, multi-domain systems that integrate aerial, ground, or marine capabilities that can support complex Arctic or coastal missions, including personnel and equipment transport as well as environmental or operational monitoring, under Arctic and coastal conditions.